

path to your next location. But the developers have gone easy on us by placing the weapons later in the game. The weapon system is rewarding when you kill using the chainsaw since it drops a lot of ammo.

G(I)ory kills

To break away from just letting you put bullets into the demons, Id has implemented the Glory Kill system, and they are a treat to execute and watch. Essentially, when you've dealt a lot of damage to a demon, they start glowing blue and as you near them, they glow orange, which is your cue to tear them apart with your bare hands in a grotesque way. These kills aren't only for your viewing pleasure but they have an added mechanic of dropping health that has managed to save our lives several times while facing demon waves. Glory kills are different for each demon and trust us when we say that you won't get tired of using it over and over again. There are multiple animations for them, dependent on the location and body part you aim before going for a glory kill.

Levels and demons

There's a lot of verticality to the game, and double jump enhances exploration. The levels are huge, with a lot of area to cover, and the more you explore, the better chances of having

your health and ammo bar always filled up. Movement feels smooth throughout and they have incorporated nostalgic Easter eggs in the game that you wouldn't want to miss. One of them includes small areas from the original 1993 Doom game preserved with the same graphics. One such area is available in every level and you'll need to keep a lookout on a lever that opens up a wall somewhere on the map. After a quick breeze through a couple of levels, you'll be convinced how the game encourages you to look around every corner of the map, since at times it becomes your only hope to stay alive. Another advantage to enter-

TESTING RIG

MOTHERBOARD: AsRock Z170 Extreme7+

CPU: Intel Core i7-6700K

RAM: Corsair Vengeance DDR4 (2x16GB)

GPU: Zotac GTX 980 AMP! Extreme (Graphics), Zotac GTX 970 AMP! Extreme (PhysX)

STORAGE: SanDisk Extreme II SSD

PSU: Corsair HX1050

MONITOR: BenQ BL3201PT

MOAR

DEVELOPER: id Software

PUBLISHER: Bethesda Softworks

PLATFORM: PC, PS4, Xbox One

PRICE: ₹2,999 (PC), ₹3,199 (PS4), ₹3,499 (Xbox One)

ing every crevice you find on the map is coming across their hidden (not too hard to find) rune trials. The rune system gives to access to special abilities and power-ups that can be equipped from the inventory.

Blowing up demons and pulling their limbs apart is a gorily beautiful affair because of the way it has been implemented. You'll come across a new demon at every level, and once you're aware of their abilities and movements, they appear in hordes later and show no mercy. Further in the game, you'll also have boss fights, an essential part of a DOOM game. When waves of demons attack, your best bet would be to never stop moving. You'll be losing health drastically and while you shoot them down, you will need to keep collecting health and ammo on the way. Horde fights occur at huge arenas which can be scaled vertically and once you collect the Jump Boots, double jump highly affects the gameplay. Some levels do include a lot of jumping over to platforms and stone slabs, especially in Hell, but once you've mastered double-jumping, it becomes easy.

Performance

Speaking about the performance, Doom doesn't fall short anywhere. At times, you'll be surrounded with hordes of different types of demons in rich dynamic environments but we didn't witness any stuttering or tearing. "PC gaming is in our DNA here at id", says a blog post from Bethesda and they have rightfully delivered. We ran the game on an i7-6700K machine with the GTX 980 pushing graphics and a GTX 970 tackling PhysX. On maxed out settings, we were able to achieve about 160 fps at 1920x1080 resolution while we hit a maximum fps of 40 on 4k resolution. Sometimes, we observed the framerate capping at 60 fps even though V-sync had been turned off. Upon investigating online, the temporary fix was to switch between windowed mode and back to fullscreen mode. Other than that, there weren't any qualms. *

